

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/10: Rationalist starting problem and connected 3-1-infinity sequence

CENTRAL QUESTION: CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD?

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+--> METHOD: a priori principles + intuition + deduction

+--> METAPHYSICS: substance, attribute, mode and sufficient explanation

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DESCARTES: God + mind + body -> interaction problem

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SPINOZA: one God/Nature -> parallelism + necessity -> individuality problem

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LEIBNIZ: many monads -> harmony + contingency -> economy and evil problem

MEMORY: substance 3-1-infinity; mind-body I-P-H.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/10: Cartesian methodic doubt, cogito and first certainty

FOUR METHOD RULES: evidence -> division -> simple-to-complex order -> complete review

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SENSE ERROR -> DREAM ARGUMENT -> EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS

| suspend every belief that can be doubted

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COGITO: I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK

| immediate intuition, not a syllogism

+--> clear and distinct perception becomes the model

+--> intuition supplies first principles; deduction orders consequences

LIMIT: present thinking is certain; enduring res cogitans needs further argument.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/10: Cartesian knowledge architecture and Circle objection

COGITO -> IDEAS -> GOD -> NON-DECEPTION -> MATHEMATICS AND EXTERNAL RES EXTENSA

IDEAS: innate / adventitious / factitious; objective reality = representational content

GOD: causal adequacy or trademark route + ontological route; present cautiously

WAX: intellect judges extended, flexible, changeable identity beyond sensory qualities

CIRCLE: clear/distinct premises prove God -> God guarantees clear/distinct truth

REPLY: present intuition compels; God secures memory and extended reasoning

RESIDUAL: the divine proofs themselves use inferential premises

WORLD: involuntary sensory ideas require an active cause; veracity blocks deception

LIMIT: body-existence is stronger than exact resemblance of sensible qualities.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/10: Descartes on substance, interaction and freedom

GOD = INFINITE SUBSTANCE, ABSOLUTELY INDEPENDENT

  +--> RES COGITANS: attribute thought; modes include ideas and volitions

  +--> RES EXTENSA: attribute extension; modes include shape and motion

REAL DISTINCTION: clear conception of each without the other

SUBSTANTIAL UNION: one embodied person experiences cross-domain coordination

OBJECTION: how can unextended mind cause extended motion? causal-closure pressure

REPLY: primitive notion of union; RESIDUAL: no transparent mechanism

OTHER MINDS: inferred through embodied behaviour, not given by the cogito

FREEDOM: will assents or withholds; error occurs when will outruns intellect

LIMIT: created substances depend continuously on God.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/10: Spinoza's substance-attribute-mode hierarchy and immanent God

ONE SELF-CAUSED, NECESSARILY EXISTING, ABSOLUTELY INFINITE SUBSTANCE

= DEUS SIVE NATURA

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infinitely many ATTRIBUTES

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humans know THOUGHT and EXTENSION

|

finite minds and bodies are MODES

GOD = immanent cause; whatever is, is in God; no external created realm

OBJECTION: acosmism; REPLY: modes retain dependent reality.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/10: Spinoza's parallelism and route from bondage to freedom

ONE EVENT -> under THOUGHT: idea -> under EXTENSION: body-state  
ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS  
NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction  
FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes  
CONATUS = each thing's striving to persevere in being  
INADEQUATE IDEAS + external causes -> passive affects -> BONDAGE  
COMMON NOTIONS / REASON / INTUITION -> ADEQUATE IDEAS -> ACTIVITY  
FREEDOM = acting from understood nature within necessity, not uncaused choice  
LIMIT: autonomy survives, but alternative possibilities do not.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/10: Leibniz's monad hierarchy, perception and individuality

WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple

GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence

RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency

ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception

BARE MONADS: obscure petites perceptions

EVERY MONAD: simple, unextended, windowless, perceptive and appetitive

APPETITION = internal transition; each perspective expresses the universe

IDENTITY OF INDISCERNIBLES secures uniqueness

BODIES = well-founded phenomena, not ultimate substances.

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/10: Leibnizian harmony, sufficient reason, contingency and freedom

GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON  
+--> mind-monad states unfold internally  
+--> bodily/organic states unfold internally  
+--> PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction  
TRUTHS OF REASON: opposite contradictory -> logically necessary  
TRUTHS OF FACT: opposite conceivable -> contingent though certain  
COMPLETE CONCEPT: all predicates belong to the individual known fully by God  
FREEDOM: spontaneity + intelligence + contingency; reasons incline, not coerce  
OBJECTION: programming/evil; REPLY: self-expression + optimal compossibility  
LIMIT: compatibility is stronger than libertarian freedom.



## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/10: Three rationalist systems compared on matched axes

| +                                                                             | +                 | +                 | +                       | + |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------------|---|
| AXIS                                                                          | DESCARTES         | SPINOZA           | LEIBNIZ                 |   |
| +                                                                             | +                 | +                 | +                       | + |
| substance                                                                     | God + mind + body | one God or Nature | many simple monads      |   |
| God                                                                           | creator/guarantee | immanent reality  | selector/coordinator    |   |
| mind-body                                                                     | interactionism    | parallelism       | harmony                 |   |
| order                                                                         | mechanism + will  | strict necessity  | certain/contingent      |   |
| freedom                                                                       | rational assent   | adequate activity | intelligent spontaneity |   |
| +                                                                             | +                 | +                 | +                       | + |
| PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap -> monist unity -> restored individuality. |                   |                   |                         |   |

## ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/10: Criticism-reply ledger, traps, PYQ routes and answer spine

DESCARTES: interaction gap -> primitive union -> mechanism remains opaque

SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism -> adequate activity + modal reality -> no alternatives

LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy -> spontaneity + possible worlds -> residual pressure

PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism

PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom

PYQ ROUTES: certainty/self-world; substance 3-1-infinity; pantheism; freedom

PYQ ROUTES: innate ideas; monads/harmony; God; determination/negation

ANSWER SPINE:

directive -> thesis -> definitions -> argument -> example -> objection -> reply -> verdict

CONTROL: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

VERDICT: intelligibility is gained at recurring costs to interaction and autonomy.